

سُورَةُ التَّكْوِيْنِ

102

Sūrat at-Takāthur

Competition in Increase — an āyah-by-āyah tafsīr

Drawing on Ibn Kathīr · as-Sa'dī · al-Jalālayn · aṭ-Ṭabarī · al-Qurṭubī · al-Baghawī

The Sūrah at a glance

8

āyāt

102

in muṣḥaf order

30

juz' ('Ammā)

Makkī

per the majority

Names of the sūrah

- At-Takāthur — “competing in increase”, from āyah 1
- Alhākum — its opening word

Central theme

Rivalry for more — wealth, children, status — distracts people until they reach the graves. Then they will know: they will see Hellfire with certainty, and they will be asked about every blessing they enjoyed.

“My wealth, my wealth!”

Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim — ‘Abdullāh ibn ash-Shikhkhīr رضي الله عنه

He came to the Prophet ﷺ while he was reciting Alhākumut-takāthur, and he said:

“The son of Ādam says: ‘My wealth, my wealth!’ But do you own of your wealth anything except what you ate and consumed, what you wore and wore out, or what you gave in charity and sent ahead?”

Everything else he leaves behind for others.

A valley of gold

“If the son of Ādam had a valley of gold, he would want a second; nothing fills his mouth but dust” (al-Bukhārī, Muslim).

Three follow the dead

Family, wealth and deeds follow him to the grave; two return and only his deeds remain (al-Bukhārī, Muslim).

The tafsīr sources in this deck



Ibn Kathīr

d. 774 AH

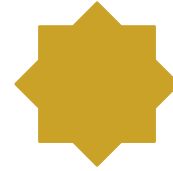
Tafsīr al-Qur'ān al-'Aẓīm — explains Qur'ān by Qur'ān, then Sunnah, then the Companions and Tābi'ūn.



as-Sa'dī

d. 1376 AH

Taysīr al-Karīm ar-Raḥmān — concise, focused on meanings, guidance and practical lessons.



al-Jalālayn

al-Maḥallī & as-Suyūṭī

Tafsīr al-Jalālayn — a word-by-word gloss; brief and precise in its definitions.



Others

aṭ-Ṭabarī • al-Qurṭubī • al-Baghawī

Used for the range of early opinions, language and further points.

Note: tafsīr points are summarised and paraphrased in English — check against the Arabic originals before teaching.

Three movements in eight āyāt

1-2

The distraction

Rivalry for more occupies you — until you visit the graves.

3-5

The warning

“No! You will come to know” — twice.
If you only knew with certainty...

6-8

Certainty & questioning

You will see Hellfire with the eye of certainty, then be asked about every blessing.

Āyah 1-2 · Distracted until the graves



أَهَاكُمْ التَّكَاثُرُ ﴿١﴾ حَتَّىٰ زُرْتُمُ الْمَقَابِرَ

Competition in [worldly] increase diverts you until you visit the graveyards.

Ibn Kathīr

Love of this world, its pleasures and adornments has distracted you from seeking the Hereafter — until death comes, you visit the graves and become one of their people. He cites the ḥadīth: “My wealth, my wealth...” (Muslim).

as-Sa‘dī

Rivalry in wealth and children distracted you from what you were created for — worship of Allah — until you died. It is called a “visit” because the grave is a stop on the way to the abode of permanence.

al-Jalālayn

Boasting in wealth, children and men distracted you from obedience until you died and were buried — or, it is said, until you counted even the dead in your boasting.

Āyah 3–4 · You will come to know



كَلَّا سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٣﴾ ثُمَّ كَلَّا سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ

No! You are going to know. Then no! You are going to know.

Ibn Kathīr

Al-Ḥasan al-Baṣrī: this is a threat followed by another threat. The repetition is for emphasis and warning.

as-Sa‘dī

You will know the outcome of what distracted you — first in the grave, then on the Day of Resurrection.

al-Jalālayn

Kallā: a stern rebuke. You will know the evil end of your rivalry — at death, then again in the grave.

Āyah 5 · If you only knew with certainty



كَلَّا لَوْ تَعْلَمُونَ عِلْمَ الْيَقِينِ

No! If you only knew with knowledge of certainty...

Ibn Kathīr

If you truly knew, you would not have been distracted by rivalry for this world from seeking the Hereafter until you reached the graves.

as-Sa‘dī

Had knowledge reached your hearts, it would not have distracted you. Lack of true, certain knowledge is what brought you to this.

al-Jalālayn

If you knew with certainty its outcome, you would not have been busied by it. The answer of “if” is left unsaid to magnify it.

Āyah 6–7 • Seeing Hellfire



لَتَرَوُنَّ الْجَحِيمَ ﴿٦﴾ ثُمَّ لَتَرَوُنَّهَا عَيْنَ الْيَقِينِ

You will surely see the Hellfire. Then you will surely see it with the eye of certainty.

Ibn Kathīr

This is the substance of the warning: you will see Jahannam, then see it with your own eyes — certainty by sight, leaving no doubt.

as-Sa‘dī

You will see it on the Day of Resurrection — a seeing of certainty, with your own eyes.

al-Jalālayn

La-tarawunna: the answer to an implied oath. ‘Ayn al-yaqīn: seeing it directly — certainty by witnessing.

Āyah 8 · Asked about every blessing



ثُمَّ لَتَسْأَلُنَّ يَوْمَئِذٍ عَنِ النَّعِيمِ

Then you will surely be asked that Day about pleasure.

Ibn Kathīr

You will be asked about gratitude for the blessings: health, security, provision. He cites Muslim: the Prophet ﷺ, Abū Bakr and ‘Umar, hungry, were fed dates, meat and water by an Anṣārī, and he ﷺ said: “You will be asked about this blessing.”

as-Sa’dī

You will be asked whether you thanked Allah for His blessings and used them in His obedience — or were ungrateful and used them in disobedience.

al-Jalālayn

About the pleasures of this world you enjoyed: health, free time, security, food and drink, and more.

Key words of the sūrah

alhākum

diverted, distracted you

أَلْهَأَكُمُ

at-takāthur

rivalry for more

التَّكَاثُرُ

zurtum

you visited — i.e. were buried

زُرْتُمْ

al-maqābir

the graves

الْمَقَابِرِ

kallā

no indeed! — a stern rebuke

كَلَّا

‘ilm al-yaqīn

knowledge of certainty

عِلْمَ الْيَقِينِ

‘ayn al-yaqīn

the eye of certainty

عَيْنَ الْيَقِينِ

an-na‘īm

blessings, pleasures

النَّعِيمِ

From the wider tafsīr tradition

aṭ-Ṭabarī

Reads takāthur broadly — rivalry in wealth, children and numbers — and holds that the “visit” to the graves is death itself.

al-Qurṭubī

Explains three levels of certainty: ‘ilm al-yaqīn (knowing), ‘ayn al-yaqīn (seeing, āyah 7) and ḥaqq al-yaqīn (experiencing, al-Wāqī‘ah 56:95).

al-Baghawī

On na‘īm he relays the ḥadīth: “Two blessings many people are cheated of: health and free time” (al-Bukhārī).

What distracts, what remains

التَّكَاثُرُ

What distracts

- More wealth than the next person
- More followers, more status
- Bigger house, newer things

→ All left behind at the grave

الْبَاقِيَاتُ الصَّالِحَاتُ

What remains (al-Kahf 18:46)

- What you gave in charity, sent ahead
- Deeds that follow you into the grave
- Health and time spent in obedience

→ Gratitude for every blessing

Lessons to carry



Name the distraction

Rivalry for more is the default trap (āyah 1).



Remember the graves

Every “more” ends in the same visit (āyah 2).



Take the warning twice

Allah repeats it so we don't miss it (āyāt 3–4).



Seek real certainty

Knowledge that reaches the heart changes priorities (āyah 5).



Believe before you see

One day it will be seen — benefit from belief now (āyāt 6–7).



Thank Allah for the small

Even dates and water will be asked about (āyah 8).

ثُمَّ لَتَسْأَلَنَّ يَوْمَئِذٍ عَنِ النَّعِيمِ

“Then you will surely be asked that Day about every blessing.” — 102:8



References

Ibn Kathīr, Tafsīr al-Qur’ān al-‘Aẓīm · as-Sa’dī, Taysīr al-Karīm ar-Raḥmān · al-Maḥallī & as-Suyūṭī, Tafsīr al-Jalālayn · aṭ-Ṭabarī, Jāmi‘ al-Bayān · al-Qurṭubī, al-Jāmi‘ li-Aḥkām al-Qur’ān · al-Baghawī, Ma‘ālim at-Tanzīl · Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 2038, 2958, 1048, 2960; Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6412, 6439, 6514